MIL-C-40121D
17 October 1983
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-40121C
5 March 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CASE, HANDCUFFS, LEATHER, BLACK

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers one type and size black leather case for handcuffs.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-1249	-	Paper, Wrapping, Tissue
V-T-285	-	Thread, Polyester
KK-L-271	-	Leather, Cattlehide, Strap, Vegetable Tanned
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8465

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MILITARY

MIL-F-10884 - Fasteners, Snap

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

DRAWING

US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT LABORATORIES

2-2-140 - Case, Handcuffs, Leather, Black

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order or precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2 and 6.4).

3.2 Materials and components. The materials and components shall be as specified herein.

3.2.1 Leather. Leather shall conform to any type, class 1 of KK-L-271 and shall be dyed and finished smoothly on the grain side. The leather shall be black in color, insuring a long-lasting lustrous finish.

3.2.2 Thread, polyester. Polyester thread shall conform to type I, class 1, subclass A, size 3 of V-T-285. The color of the thread shall be black and shall show fastness to weathering equal to or better than the standard shade sample (see 6.3). If no standard shade sample is available, the thread shall show good fastness to weathering.

3.2.3 Fastener, snap. Snap fasteners shall consist of a size 2 button with socket for the female half and a size 2 eyelet with stud for the male half, conforming to style 2A, finish 2 of MIL-F-10884.

3.3 Construction. Construction of the case shall conform to Drawing 2-2-140 and shall be as specified herein.

3.3.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of stitching shall be backstitched or overstitched not less than 1 inch except where ends are turned under or caught in other seams and stitching. Thread tensions shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn. The lock shall be imbedded in the materials sewed.

3.3.1.1 Thread breaks. Thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occurring during the sewing operation shall be repaired by restarting the stitching one stitch before the break or run-out.

3.3.1.2 Skipped stitches, run-offs or breaks. Run-offs, thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped stitches noted during inspection shall be repaired by overstitching, starting one stitch in back of the defective area, continuing over the defective area, and finishing one stitch beyond the defective area.

3.3.2 Setting of snap fasteners. A hole shall be prepunched to receive the button and eyelet components of the snap fasteners. The hole shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the button and eyelet barrels so that the barrel must be

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forced through the hole. The hole shall not be punched in the setting operation with the button or eyelet barrel. The fasteners shall be securely clinched without cutting the adjacent materials and no more than two splits shall occur in the button or eyelet barrels.

3.3.3 Burnishing. The double edges of the body and pocket piece, when sewed together, and the edge of the flap, shall be treated with a colorless aqueous solution of a sealer and then burnished. A solution of gum tragacanth has been found suitable.

3.4 Workmanship. The case shall be clean and free from grease and dirt. Leather components shall be free from any cut, damaged grain, scratch, hole, brand, hip mark and loose spongy leather. Burnished edges shall be smooth and free from roughness. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. All thread ends shall be tied and fused.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4. The presence of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

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4.4.1.1 Certification. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance certifying that the sealer conforms to the requirements specified in 3.3.3.

4.4.2 In-process examination. Examination shall be made of the following operations to establish conformance to specified requirements. Whenever non-conformance is noted, correction shall be made to the items affected and to the operation.

(a)	Setting of snap fasteners into prepunched holes	3.3.2
(b)	Cutting of leather components before forming	Drawing 2-2-140
(c)	Application of sealer to edges of leather components	3.3.3

4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cases. The sample unit shall be one case. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE I. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Leather	Not black in color	X	
	Burnish missing on edges when required		X
	Any hole, cut or rupture	X	
	Brand markm healed grub damage, scar tissue, hip mark, brittle or bony area	1/	
	Abraded, scratched, or other grain damage	1/	
	Flanky, spongy, pipey or stretchy leather	1/	
	Any wrinkle	1/	
	Slaughter cut	1/	
	Not smooth finished		X
	Not dyed and finished on grain side	X	
	Flesh side not free of loose flesh		X
	Burnished edges are rough		X
Thread	Not black in color	X	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Stitching	Not type specified	X	
	One stitch less than minimum specified		X
	Two or more stitches less than minimum specified	X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified		X
	Any open seam not repaired	X	
	Repair of an open seam not performed as specified		X
	NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when a run-off occurs, when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutively skipped stitches occur.		
	Loose tension, resulting in a loosely secured seam	X	
	Tight tension, resulting in damage to the leather		X
Snap fastener	Any fastener not functioning properly i.e., fails to snap closed, to provide a secure closure, or to open freely	X	
	NOTE: The fasteners shall be snapped and unsnapped twice to determine whether parts of fastener separate freely and also effect a secure closure.		
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting adjacent material	X	
	Clnched loosely, permitting any component to rotate freely but not to the degree that any component can be expected to become detached during use		X
	Clinched loosely to the degree that components can be expected to become detached during use	X	

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TABLE I. End item visual defects (cont'd)

Examine		Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Snap fastener (cont'd)	NOTE:	Incomplete roll of end of button or eyelet barrel is evidence of improper and insecure clinching.		
		Incorrect style	X	
		More than two splits in eyelet or button barrels		X
Construction and workmanship		Any part not fabricated of the specified materials	X	
		Any component not fabricated as specified, e.g., grain side of leather not on exterior surface of case	X	
		Thread ends not tied		X
		Thread ends not fused		X
		Case not clean, e.g., evidence of grease or dirt.		X

1/ Defect shall be scored as major when seriously affeting serviceability or appearance, and as minor when affecting serviceability or appearance but not seriously.

4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the specified dimensions. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of cases. The sample unit shall be one case. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.5 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged with the exception that it need not be closed. Examination of closure defects listed below shall be made on shipping containers fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

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Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Case not closed. Closed case not completely inclosed in tissue paper. Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flap, loose strapping, improper taping, or inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Contents	Number of cases per intermediate pack, is more or less than required. 1/ Number of intermediate packs per container is more or less than required.

1/ For this defect, two intermediate packs shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each closed case shall be completely inclosed in a wrap of tissue paper conforming to type I, of A-A-1249. Ten wrapped cases shall then be positioned on their side and packed in an intermediate paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III, type G, class i of PPP-B-566; or to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Inside dimensions of each paperboard box shall be approximately 12-1/2 inches in length, 5-3/8 inches in width and 3-5/8 inches in depth. Box closure shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade A of PPP-T-45, applied at the center of the length opening and extending along the bottom and up the sides at least 1 inch.

5.1.2 Commercial. The cases shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Two hundred and forty cases, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to grade V3s, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed flat, two in length, three in width, and four in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 25-1/2 inches in length, 17 inches in width, and 15 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

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5.2.2 Level B packing. Two hundred and forty cases, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed flat, two in length, three in width, and four in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 25-1/2 inches in length, 17 inches in width and 15 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.5.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Cases, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, intermediate packs and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The case is intended for carrying the handcuffs specified in MIL-H-20050.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this document.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.4).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The quantity of items required should be as specified in the contract. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-40121D	Case, Handcuffs, Leather, Black

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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